



# How to Read a Job Posting

*Job Readiness • realistic sample postings included*

## FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

**Purpose:** Teach students to locate pay, schedule, duties, requirements, and hidden deal-breakers.

**Materials:** This packet + highlighter if available.

**Easy flow:** 5 min: explain required vs preferred • 15 min: analyze postings • 5 min: compare • 5 min: discuss.

## Job Posting Detective Checklist

- |                                                  |                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Job title               | <input type="checkbox"/> Hourly pay or salary     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Full-time or part-time  | <input type="checkbox"/> Days/hours               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Weekend requirement     | <input type="checkbox"/> Main duties              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Required qualifications | <input type="checkbox"/> Preferred qualifications |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Physical requirements   | <input type="checkbox"/> Transportation/location  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Benefits                | <input type="checkbox"/> How to apply             |

# Sample Job Posting 1

|          |                                             |
|----------|---------------------------------------------|
| POSITION | Grocery Stock Associate                     |
| PAY      | \$14.50/hour                                |
| STATUS   | Part-time • 20-28 hrs/week                  |
| SCHEDULE | Afternoons/evenings; some weekends required |

## What You Would Do

- ☐ Stock shelves and rotate products
- ☐ Unload deliveries
- ☐ Help customers locate items
- ☐ Keep aisles clean

## Requirements

- ☐ Must be 16+
- ☐ Able to lift up to 40 lb
- ☐ Reliable attendance

## Preferred

- ☐ Previous retail experience preferred, not required

## Job Posting Detective

What is the pay? \_\_\_\_\_

Write one schedule requirement.

\_\_\_\_\_

Name two duties. \_\_\_\_\_

What is REQUIRED? \_\_\_\_\_

What is only PREFERRED?

\_\_\_\_\_

Circle one detail that could be a deal-breaker for some applicants.

\_\_\_\_\_

Would you apply? Use TWO facts from the posting.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Sample Job Posting 2

|          |                                         |
|----------|-----------------------------------------|
| POSITION | Auto Detail Assistant                   |
| PAY      | \$15.75/hour                            |
| STATUS   | Part-time • 24-30 hrs/week              |
| SCHEDULE | Mon-Fri 2:30-7:30 PM; Saturday rotation |

### What You Would Do

- ☐ Vacuum and wipe interiors
- ☐ Wash exterior surfaces
- ☐ Move supplies
- ☐ Follow chemical-safety directions

### Requirements

- ☐ Valid driver's license preferred for moving vehicles
- ☐ Able to work outdoors
- ☐ Able to stand for long periods

### Preferred

- ☐ Detailing experience helpful

### Job Posting Detective

What is the pay? \_\_\_\_\_

Write one schedule requirement.

\_\_\_\_\_

Name two duties. \_\_\_\_\_

What is REQUIRED? \_\_\_\_\_

What is only PREFERRED?

\_\_\_\_\_

Circle one detail that could be a deal-breaker for some applicants.

\_\_\_\_\_

Would you apply? Use TWO facts from the posting.

\_\_\_\_\_

## Sample Job Posting 3

|          |                             |
|----------|-----------------------------|
| POSITION | Childcare Program Assistant |
| PAY      | \$13.25/hour                |
| STATUS   | Part-time • 15-20 hrs/week  |
| SCHEDULE | School days 3:00-6:00 PM    |

### What You Would Do

- ☐ Supervise activities
- ☐ Prepare simple snacks
- ☐ Clean activity areas
- ☐ Communicate with families and staff

### Requirements

- ☐ Must be dependable
- ☐ Background check required if 18+
- ☐ Comfortable working with children

### Preferred

- ☐ CPR/First Aid preferred

### Job Posting Detective

What is the pay? \_\_\_\_\_

Write one schedule requirement.

\_\_\_\_\_

Name two duties. \_\_\_\_\_

What is REQUIRED? \_\_\_\_\_

What is only PREFERRED?

\_\_\_\_\_

Circle one detail that could be a deal-breaker for some applicants.

\_\_\_\_\_

Would you apply? Use TWO facts from the posting.

\_\_\_\_\_

# Compare the Three Jobs

| Job                         | Pay          | Schedule Fit? | Biggest Requirement | My Rank |
|-----------------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------------|---------|
| Grocery Stock Associate     | \$14.50/hour |               |                     |         |
| Auto Detail Assistant       | \$15.75/hour |               |                     |         |
| Childcare Program Assistant | \$13.25/hour |               |                     |         |

## Wrap-Up • Get Them Talking

Which posting gave you the clearest information?

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What information was missing that you would ask before accepting?

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Why can a higher hourly wage still be the worse job for someone?

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